



An Coimisiún
um Rialáil Fónais
**Commission for
Regulation of Utilities**

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Commission for Regulation of Utilities

National Energy Demand Strategy Annual Update 2026

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CRU Strategic Plan 2025-27

The CRU's vision, purpose and values are set out in the graphic below. This is taken from the Strategic Plan 2025-27¹, which underpins the CRU's role in regulating Ireland's evolving energy and water sectors, and ensures that essential services are delivered efficiently, safely, and in line with national policy objectives.

Vision, Purpose, and Values



OUR VISION:

Resilient, efficient, sustainable, and safe energy and water services for Ireland.



OUR PURPOSE:

We actively serve the public interest by regulating the provision of energy and water to Irish homes and businesses, while supporting the transformation to net zero.



OUR VALUES:

• Integrity • Professionalism • Openness • Accountability

¹ <https://www.cru.ie/about-us/news/strategic-plan-2025/>

Executive Summary

The Commission for Regulation of Utilities (CRU) published the first National Energy Demand Strategy (NEDS) Decision in July 2024 (CRU202467) with the aim of enhancing Ireland's energy demand flexibility in a coordinated phased manner to support a more sustainable, cost-effective, and secure energy system.

This Annual Update demonstrates that the NEDS implementation is progressing well, with a majority of actions now delivered or on track, while recognising that delivery is increasingly complex and requires strengthened coordination across Government, regulators and system operators.

This publication is the third NEDS update, with one further update expected in this series to close out the NEDS implementation phase in due course.

Since the previous NEDS update was published in July 2025, an additional 18 actions have been completed, bringing the total number to 34 of 53 actions delivered to date. At the same time, the CRU has undertaken a structured review of delivery timelines, resulting in the rebaselining of 16 actions to reflect evolving policy, market, and operational dependencies. This rebaselining reflects a maturing implementation phase, as NEDS actions become more closely integrated with wider national and European policy developments.

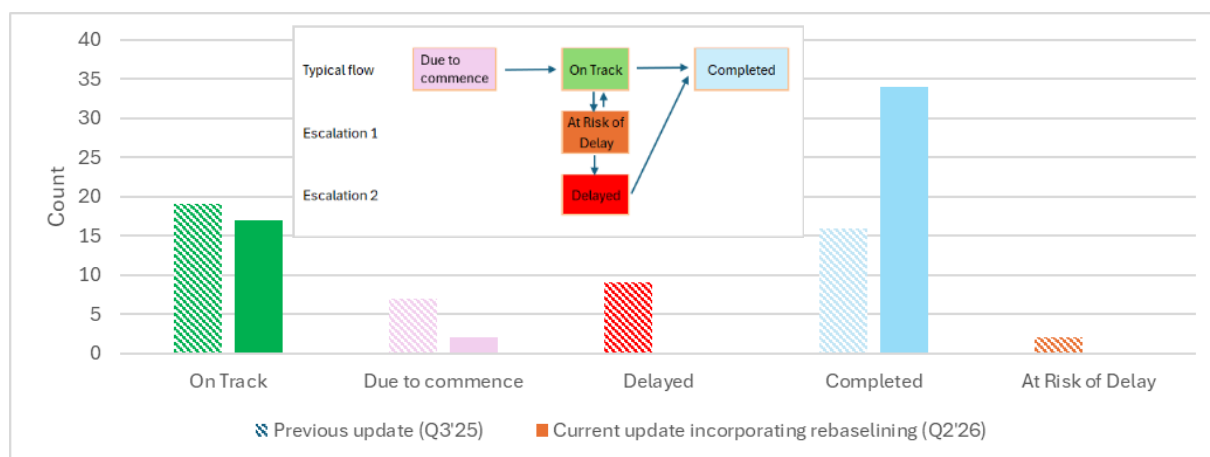


Figure: An overview of the status of NEDS actions. Q3 2025 updates are illustrated in the first columns (hatching), with the latest updates for Q2 2026 shown in the second columns (solid).

A number of key developments have advanced since the previous update:

- **Large Energy Users Action Plan (LEAP)**, approved by Government in January 2026, establishes a coordinated national approach to planning and enabling large-scale demand growth, including the development of green energy parks and associated infrastructure;

- Continued progress in the **National Smart Metering Programme**, with over 2.1 million meters installed, supporting the rollout of smart tariffs and data-enabled services;
- Advancement of **flexibility market frameworks**, including ESBN's demand flexibility procurement and EirGrid's Long Duration Energy Storage (LDES) programme;
- Ongoing development of the **Flexibility Needs Assessment (FNA)** under ACER, which will play a central role in setting future flexibility targets and may inform the evolution of NEDS in the medium term.

Stakeholder feedback, gathered through the online NEDS Review Survey (February 2026), indicates strong support for the direction of the strategy, with particular recognition of progress in smart metering, flexibility procurement, and large user policy. However, stakeholders emphasised the need to accelerate delivery of dynamic tariffs, network tariff reform, and customer participation measures, alongside improved programme coordination.

Looking ahead, the next phase of NEDS implementation will require a more integrated, cross-government approach. The scale and complexity of demand growth — particularly from Large Energy Users (LEUs) — and the increasing interaction with EU frameworks (including the FNA and Demand Response Network Code) mean that future strategy development will need to extend beyond the CRU's remit alone.

The CRU will continue to monitor the delivery of flexibility through the NEDS, including through the forthcoming **Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 (CRU202629)**, while engaging with Government Departments on the future direction and governance of a next iteration of the strategy.

Public / Customer Impact Statement

The CRU launched the National Energy Demand Strategy (NEDS) in July 2024 in response to the Government's Climate Action Plan 2023 (CAP23) to enhance Ireland's energy demand flexibility with a view to supporting a more sustainable, cost-effective, and secure energy system. In essence, if a high proportion of customers can shift their energy consumption to times when there is a significant quantity of electricity being generated by renewable generation, customers can benefit and reductions in carbon emissions can be achieved, even as overall demand for energy increases.

Demand flexibility enables and empowers energy customers to increase their use of renewable energy whilst also reducing demand during times of high-carbon intensity on the energy system. This ability to adjust consumption patterns in response to fluctuations in renewable energy output and network conditions is crucial to decarbonising Ireland's energy system and in the long term will result in a major change to how the energy system operates and in how customers organise their energy usage, from domestic households to businesses and large industrial users of energy.

The NEDS decision identified 53² high impact, short-term actions and 3 Government Department recommendations. Following the publication of the strategy, the NEDS entered its implementation phase. To ensure that a transparent, coordinated, and collaborative approach was ultimately adopted towards the implementation of the NEDS, the CRU committed to publishing a series of updates in order to monitor and provide an ongoing summary of progress and status updates on NEDS actions, recommendations, and relevant policy developments. This update is the third of such updates that have been published by the CRU to date with one further update expected in this series to close out the NEDS implementation phase in due course.

² Note that a total of 51 actions were included in the NEDS Decision Paper (CRU202467, [link](#)). However, two of these actions (Actions No. 1.11 Microgeneration operational issues, and No. 3.2 Enhanced quality and accessibility of network information) are replicated for two different responsible bodies (EirGrid and ESBN). The tracking of these actions will be reported separately; hence the total here appears as 53 actions.

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Glossary of Terms and Abbreviations

Abbreviation or Term	Definition or Meaning
ACER	EU Agency for the Cooperation of Energy Regulators
AFIR	Alternative Fuels Infrastructure Regulation
AIB	Association of Issuing Bodies
BER	Building Energy Rating
CAP23	Climate Action Plan 2023
CAP24	Climate Action Plan 2024
CEER	Council of European Energy Regulators
CPPA	Corporate Power Purchase Agreement
CRU	Commission for Regulation of Utilities
DCEE	Department of Climate, Energy and the Environment (previously DECC, the Department of Environment, Climate and Communications)
DER	Distributed Energy Resource
DETE	Department of Enterprise, Tourism and Employment
DFP	Demand Flexibility Product
DMSO	Distribution Management System Operator
DNDP	Distribution Network Development Plan
DRNC	Demand Response Network Code
DSO	Distribution System Operator
DSUs	Demand Side Units
EC	European Commission
EU	European Union
EV	Electric Vehicle
ENTSO-E	European Network of Transmission System Operators for Electricity
ENTSR	Electricity Network Tariff Structure Review

EPA	Environmental Protection Agency
ESBN	Electricity Supply Board (ESB) Networks
ESPF	Electricity Storage Policy Framework
FMD	Fuel Mix Disclosure
FNA	Flexibility Needs Assessment
GNI	Gas Networks Ireland
GOs	Guarantees of Origin
HDV	Heavy Duty Vehicle
IDA	Industrial Development Agency
kW	Kilowatt
KPI	Key Performance Indicators
LDES	Long Duration Energy Storage
LEAP	Large Energy User Action Plan
LEU	Large Energy User
MaREI	Science Foundation Ireland Research Centre for Energy, Climate and Marine
MIC	Maximum Import Capacity
MO	Market Operator
MW	Megawatt
NEAT	National Energy Affordability and Transition
NEDS	National Energy Demand Strategy
NSMP	National Smart Metering Programme
NRA	National Regulatory Authorities
NSMP	National Smart Metering Programme
PCW	Price Comparison Website
PV	Photovoltaic
RAs	Regulatory Authorities
SCALE	Smart Charging Alignment for Europe

SEAI	Sustainable Energy Authority of Ireland
SECs	Sectoral Emission Ceilings
SESWG	Smart Energy Services Working Group
SLR	Special Load Readings
SO(s)	System Operator(s)
SMDAC	Smart Meter Data Access Code
SONI	Northern Ireland's Electricity Transmission System Operator
SNSP	System Non-Synchronous Penetration
ToU	Time of Use
TSO	Transmission System Operator
V2G	Vehicle to Grid
XLEU	Extra Large Energy User
ZEHDV-I	Zero Emissions Heavy Duty Vehicles – Infrastructure
ZEVI	Zero Emissions Vehicles Ireland

1. Progress and associated updates

1.1 Introduction

This NEDS publication is the third in a series of NEDS updates that the CRU has delivered since the NEDS Decision (CRU202467) was published in July 2024. The purpose of this update is to provide a clear view of delivery progress, key developments and emerging challenges, as NEDS transitions from initial implementation into a more mature delivery phase.

While the first two NEDS updates were published on a biannual basis, a decision was made to transition to an annual basis, which is commensurate with the advancement of the strategy's implementation.

Since the previous update (July 2025), the context for the NEDS delivery has continued to evolve, with significant developments across Government policy (including the Large Energy Users Action Plan (LEAP)), regulatory frameworks, and European initiatives such as the Flexibility Needs Assessment (FNA).

This update reflects progress against actions, but also positions that progress within a broader and increasingly integrated policy landscape.

1.2 Policy Context and Strategic Alignment

1 Policy Context and Strategic Alignment

The NEDS sits within a broader and evolving policy landscape at a national and European level, aimed at delivering Ireland's climate, energy, and economic objectives.

At a national level, the **Climate Action Plan (CAP)** provides the overarching framework for emissions reduction targets and sectoral actions, including the development of demand-side flexibility as a key enabler of a decarbonised electricity system. NEDS supports the delivery of CAP objectives by identifying and coordinating specific actions required to enable flexibility across the energy system.

More recently, the **Large Energy Users Action Plan (LEAP)**, approved by Government in January 2026, establishes a strategic framework for accommodating significant growth in electricity demand from energy-intensive sectors, including data centres. LEAP focuses on coordinated infrastructure delivery, spatial planning, and enabling large-scale demand-side flexibility.

There are clear interdependencies between NEDS and LEAP, particularly in relation to LEUs, flexibility markets, and network planning. While NEDS focuses on system-wide demand flexibility across all customer segments, LEAP provides a more targeted, cross-government approach for a specific high-impact demand segment.

In addition, a number of other national initiatives and policy frameworks interact with NEDS, including:

- **National Energy Affordability and Transition (NEAT)**-related policy development, focusing on the distributional and consumer impacts of the energy transition;
- The **National Hydrogen Strategy** and broader **Energy Security Package**, which influence long-term system planning and the future role of electricity and gas networks;
- Ongoing work on electricity network planning and tariff reform, including the Electricity Network Tariff Structure Review.

At European level, the policy landscape is also evolving. In particular:

- The **Flexibility Needs Assessment (FNA)**, being undertaken in line with ACER methodology, will provide a system-wide assessment of Ireland's future flexibility requirements;
- The forthcoming **Demand Response Network Code (DRNC)** will introduce harmonised rules across the EU to enable demand-side participation in electricity markets.

These European developments are expected to play an increasingly important role in shaping the future design of flexibility frameworks in Ireland, and may inform or supersede elements of the current NEDS over time.

Finally, the **Programme for Government** sets the overarching political and strategic direction, including commitments on climate action, energy security, and economic development, which underpin the development of NEDS and related initiatives.

Overall, NEDS operates as a coordinating framework within this wider policy landscape, translating high-level climate and energy objectives into actionable steps to enable demand-side flexibility, while aligning with parallel initiatives that address infrastructure, large demand growth, and market design.

1.3 NEDS Implementation & Progress

Since the publication of the previous NEDS update in Q3 2025 (CRU202580), the NEDS Implementation Group has continued to oversee and monitor progress against the 53 actions and

3 recommendations for Government. This NEDS Implementation Group has continued to convene on a quarterly basis, with recent meetings having taken place in October 2025 and March 2026.

An additional 18 actions have now been completed since the previous NEDS update was published in July 2025, bringing the total number to 34 completed NEDS actions to date. This is indicative of the continuing further advancement of the implementation of the NEDS, particularly as it has been necessary to navigate through a constantly evolving Irish and global energy landscape amidst multiple legislative changes and developments, in addition to organisational and global challenges.

A variety of factors and circumstances have arisen during the course of the NEDS implementation, resulting in the need to rebaseline the completion dates for some NEDS actions, in order to reflect latest developments and updates.

A rebaselining review has been conducted of eligible NEDS actions to reflect genuine barriers, constraints, and/or dependencies encountered by action owners to date. The criteria for consideration included:

- Outstanding dependencies, i.e. where inputs are still required from external sources or third parties preventing an action from progressing through to completion;
- Immature action framing, scope growth or change, i.e. where developments in the interim since the NEDS was first published in July 2024 have led to changes materially impacting a NEDS action in a significant way;
- Resources, i.e. where a NEDS action owner may have had insufficient resources resulting in an inability to complete the action as per the original target date;
- Priority, i.e. the completion of a NEDS action may not currently be an organisational prioritisation for a particular stakeholder due to a variety of potential reasons.

Following this review, the CRU has revised the completion dates of 16 actions. These are clearly identified as such within the NEDS actions update status table provided in Section 5, and also in Figure 1 below, where such actions are now depicted as being “on track” relative to the revised completion dates that have now been applied. Of these 16 rebaselined actions, 10 are due to be completed in 2026 and the rest of the actions have delivery dates further into the future.

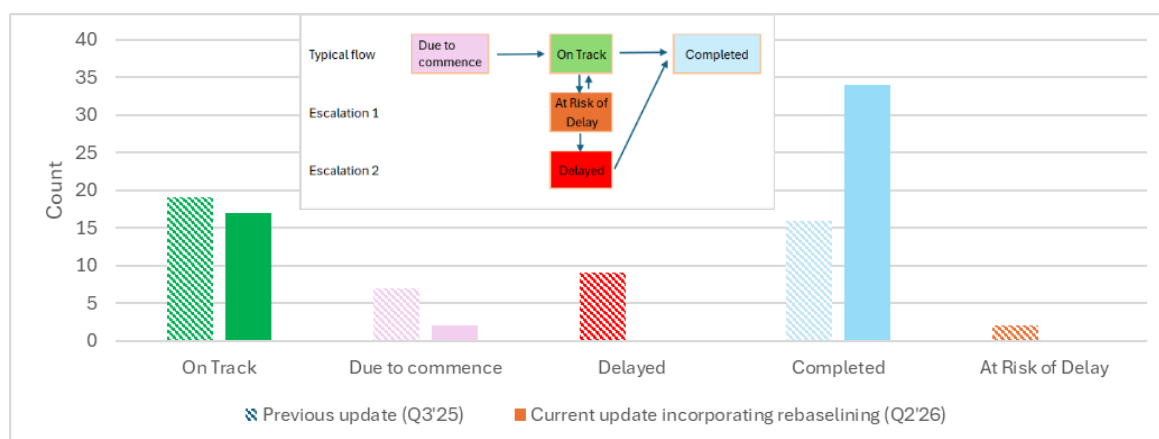


Figure 1: Summary of the current status of the NEDS actions (solid bars), compared to the previous NEDS update publication (hatched bars).

1.4 Updates on three NEDS recommendations for Government Departments

The NEDS decision in 2024 outlined three key recommendations for Government Departments, particularly DCEE and DETE, to support the implementation of the NEDS. Updates on progress that has been made on each of these recommendations to date are summarised below.

1. Policy measures regarding carbon emissions & SECs (Overall Strategy)

The first NEDS recommendation highlighted the need for Government Departments to monitor the relative contribution of different demand segments to overall carbon emissions, and to consider whether further policy measures may be required to support decarbonisation objectives, including in the context of Sectoral Emissions Ceilings (SECs).

Since the publication of the NEDS Decision, engagement has continued between the CRU and relevant Government Departments in relation to the role of demand side flexibility in supporting emissions reduction targets. This includes consideration of how policy measures, regulatory frameworks and market signals can be aligned to support decarbonisation across the electricity system.

Given the cross sectoral nature of emissions policy and its interaction with wider CAP measures, this recommendation remains under ongoing active consideration by Government Departments. The CRU, in alignment with recommendations outlined on NEDS Action 0.2, will continue to engage with relevant stakeholders on this area as part of the broader evolution of NEDS and related policy frameworks.

2. Enhanced emissions reporting framework - Part 2 (Area 2D: Demand Flexibility & Response – Information, Certification and Reporting)

The second NEDS recommendation relates to the development of an enhanced emissions reporting framework, building on existing initiatives and supporting greater transparency in relation to electricity related emissions.

Progress has been made in recent years in establishing the foundations for emissions reporting, including through the development of reporting frameworks for LEUs and ongoing work by relevant agencies. Further development of this area requires coordination across multiple bodies, including Government Departments and agencies with responsibility for emissions data, reporting, and policy design.

In this context, the delivery of a comprehensive emissions reporting framework continues to be considered as part of wider Government policy development under the Climate Action Plan.

The CRU will continue to support this work, including through its role in providing data, regulatory insights, and engagement with market participants.

3. Consider a national strategic approach for the facilitation of new LEU connections (Area 3: New Demand Connections)

The third recommendation related to the need for consideration to be given to a national strategic approach for the planning of large demand customers and associated infrastructure requirements (e.g. energy, water, broadband, transport etc.), the associated costs and benefits, and any potential risks arising from high volumes of similar demand customer types.

The LEAP was established by DETE and DCEE, and approved by Government in January 2026. LEAP seeks to enable Ireland to attract next generation investment across Ireland's regions in energy intensive sectors associated with the greatest future strategic economic opportunities by addressing barriers impacting LEU developments, including with energy infrastructure delivery. A central pillar of LEAP will be to provide a framework for the establishment of green energy parks in which to co-locate the most energy-intensive LEU sectors with the supply of renewables and other enabling technologies. It further seeks to unlock increased LEU demand side flexibility through the establishment of associated regulatory frameworks and market structures. This 'plan-led' approach will ensure alignment of Ireland's industrial, climate and energy policies, and consistency with other strategic Government priorities.

1.5 Large Energy Users Action Plan (LEAP)³

To deliver on commitments within the Programme for Government, the Large Energy User Action Plan (LEAP) was established by Department of Enterprise, Tourism and Employment (DETE) and the Department of Climate, Energy and the Environment (DCEE), and approved by Government in January 2026. LEAP seeks to enable Ireland to attract next generation investment across Ireland's regions in energy intensive sectors associated with the greatest future strategic economic opportunities by addressing barriers impacting LEU developments, including with energy infrastructure delivery. It does this, inter alia, by planning spatially for coordinated infrastructure delivery, thereby seeking to derisk these complex projects. It further seeks to unlock short-term LEU development opportunities through the effective utilisation of existing energy infrastructure, led by enhanced demand-side flexibility. This 'plan-led' approach will ensure alignment of Ireland's industrial, climate and energy policies, and consistency with other strategic Government priorities.

The implementation of LEAP's 17 actions will take place across Government, with priority workstreams to be led on and supported by Government Departments, the CRU and energy system operators (SOs). A central pillar of LEAP will be to provide a framework for the establishment of green energy parks in which to co-locate the most energy-intensive LEU sectors with the supply of renewables and other enabling technologies. LEAP also seeks to unlock increased LEU demand side flexibility through establishment of associated regulatory frameworks and market structures. DETE intends for LEAP to act as a core cross-government instrument which supports the development of flexibility for a specific high impact demand segment, in support of NEDS objectives. The critical interdependencies between LEAP and NEDS are recognised.

1.6 NEDS Review Survey

The CRU embarked on a review of the NEDS in terms of its design, focus, and progress to assess its performance to date. An online survey was published by the CRU in February 2026, which forms part of broader stakeholder engagement being undertaken by the CRU to support the ongoing implementation of the NEDS.

³ LEAP summary text has been provided by DETE.

The survey provided an opportunity for all stakeholders to provide feedback on the NEDS progress so as to contribute towards the CRUs’ review of the NEDS including a reflection of the diverse perspectives, experiences, and priorities of stakeholders across the energy system.

The NEDS Survey consisted of the following eight questions:

- 1. What type of stakeholder do you represent? Other (please specify)
- 2. Would you be willing to participate in future NEDS related consultations or feedback sessions?
- 3. Please provide your name, organisation and contact details
- 4. In your view, which NEDS focus areas and / or NEDS actions are performing well, and why?
- 5. Which NEDS focus areas and / or actions have made less progress, or need adjustment, and why?
- 6. As a result of relevant developments since the publication of the NEDS (in July 2024), would it be beneficial to publish an updated NEDS?
- 7. In your view, how has the implementation of the NEDS performed to date?
- 8. Other additional comments

As displayed in Figure 2, 18 stakeholder responses were received and the details gathered in response to questions 1 – 3 represented 13 stakeholder types (e.g. business customers, residential customers, SOs, manufacturers, retail suppliers etc.).

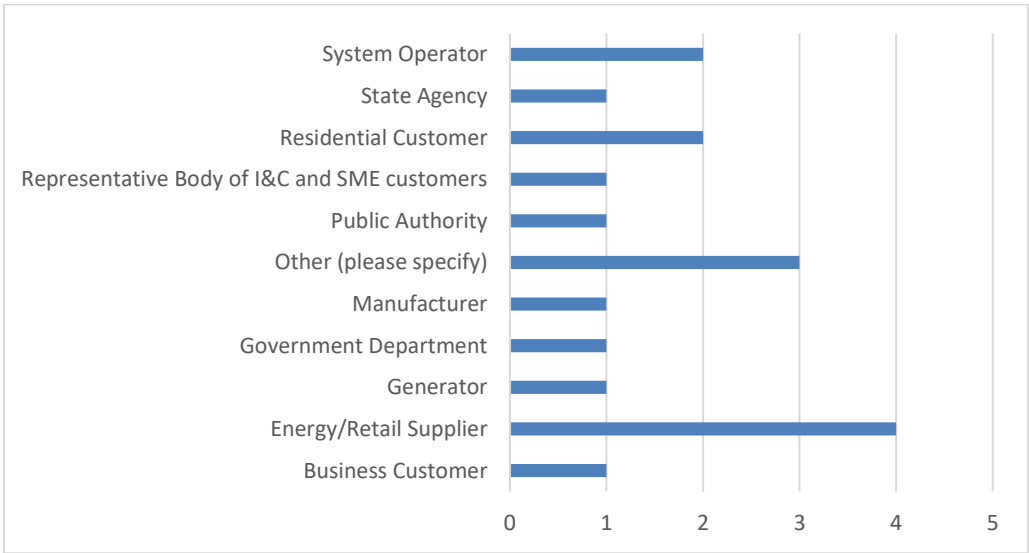


Figure 2: Number of responses to NEDS stakeholder survey per stakeholder type. The “Other” type of stakeholder includes a charity, an integrated energy supplier, and an industrial energy consultancy.

The input obtained from this survey, particularly common themes that arose in response to questions 4 – 6, has helped to inform the CRU to ensure that the NEDS remains responsive, inclusive, and impactful.

1.1.1 Common themes on NEDS areas performing well and notable achievements to date:

Stakeholders indicated that progress has been made in NEDS Areas 2 (Demand Flexibility and Response) and 3 (New Demand Connections) providing clarity for market participants and demand customers, whilst Area 1 (Smart Services) has been delivering essential building blocks for the growth of flexibility and shaping of the demand. It was also the view of stakeholders that regulatory clarity and commitment are essential in supporting industry investment decisions and sustaining momentum for consumers on the journey towards flexibility. Some NEDS workstreams of note were as follows:

▶ Smart Metering & Smart Services:

The 2million+ installs milestone and the Smart Meter Data Access Code were frequently cited as necessary building blocks for later-stage flexibility and data-driven services, such as dynamic tariffs and automated response. Stakeholders value the clarity and programme discipline underpinning this rollout.

▶ Demand Flexibility Procurement:

ESBN's local flexibility pilots/procurement and TSO white-paper activity are seen as positive market signals and provide confidence to market participants.

▶ Connections Policy:

Publication of LEU policy and related new demand connections steps are welcomed to give pathway clarity.

1.1.2 Common themes on NEDS areas that have made less progress to date or are viewed as requiring further adjustment:

Whilst it was noted that progress has been made across all NEDS areas and the strategy is focused on the right direction, stakeholders were of the view that a continued effort to align with policies and further developments must be applied to unlock the benefits of the NEDS areas. The following in particular were noted:

► **Tariffs & Price Signals:**

Stakeholders identified retail dynamic tariffs as being central to unlocking demand-side response, and how delays or uncertainty in their delivery creates risk which in turn constrains the scale and pace of implicit flexibility. Similarly, stakeholders were of the view that network tariff reform must move faster and align with the other price signals in the market to deliver the intended result and participation from commercial and LEU customers.

► **Storage, Dispatchable Demand and Non-Firm connections:**

Calls to accelerate LDES procurement/design and to clarify DSU/dispatchable consumption frameworks in coordination with infrastructure readiness, decarbonisation pathways and LEU growth – are seen by stakeholders as being prerequisites for hitting flexibility targets. In addition, industry engagement is required to promote non-firm connections and support growth in demand-side flexibility from heat and transport.

► **Customer Participation, Activation & Equity:**

Several stakeholders flagged low smart tariff adoption and a need for targeted engagement/support for vulnerable users and renters (e.g., education, access to meters, Building Energy Rating (BER) related constraints, accessing savings from smart tariffs). Consumer-centric technology and an approach to flexibility would enable mass adoption by tackling market complexity and cost inefficiency. Retail suppliers need to be included in the development of flexibility to support market access for customers and to be able to manage balancing risks arising from greater use of flexibility.

► **Execution Discipline and Coordination:**

There were recurrent stakeholder asks for sharper prioritisation, timelines, accountability and coherent programme governance across CRU, SOs, and policy makers. Stakeholders noted that having multiple workstreams and programmes with overlapping objectives, similar timescales, and involving a common group of objectives creates a potential for confusion and inefficiency. Without the appropriate coordination, visibility of activities across programmes and policy alignment the progress towards decarbonisation and flexibility goals may be hindered.

1.1.3 Additional themes of note:

► **Updated NEDS:**

The majority of stakeholders (15 responses) were in favour of an update being made to the NEDS. Proposed revised scope items included provisions to reflect the LEAP, the LEU Connection Policy decision, storage policy, energy sharing/private wires, and evolving

Corporate Power Purchase Agreements (CPPAs) / Guarantees of Origin (GO) / emissions transparency work.

Many stakeholders indicated a preference for the application of key performance indicators (KPIs) and a single, system-level implementation roadmap that would sequence dependencies and clarify accountability.

Only a minority of stakeholders sought no project scope changes at all, preferring delivery to continue to be against the current plan with frequent progress tracking.

1.1.4 Summary

Taking the opportunity to provide feedback, representatives from a number of stakeholder groups have responded to the NEDS Review Survey. Respondents noted that the NEDS has made good progress on smart metering and smart services area of actions and sent the right signals to the market through progress in flexibility procurement initiatives. However, respondents also noted that uncertainty of outcomes and delays in actions addressing key enablers for flexibility may pose a risk to the delivery of flexibility at scale. These comments are being taken into account for the rebaselining of actions and inform the approach to NEDS update.

1.7 Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 (CRU202629)

As per NEDS Action 0.3: NEDS Progress reporting, the CRU is responsible for assessing the NEDS progress in three ways: (i) by estimating the flexibility associated with NEDS initiatives, (ii) tracking progress of actions, and (iii) reviewing the impact of NEDS actions on carbon emissions. As required by this action, the CRU will be publishing a Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 (CRU202629) shortly after this NEDS Annual Update 2026 publication. The report will present an estimate of demand-side flexibility, together with a description of the methodology and assumptions upon which such an estimate has been based. The tracking of carbon emissions is separately addressed within this publication both in the update provided for Action 0.2: Review the impact of NEDS on Carbon Emissions, in the table in Section 5 and also in the closing summary for the relevant action contained in the Appendix.

1.8 CRU Large Energy Users Connection Policy Decision

The CRU published the Large Energy Users Connection Policy Decision (CRU2025236) in December 2025. The purpose of this decision paper was to set out a pathway for new data centre

applications to the electricity system to address risks in relation to security of supply and system constraints and promote renewable energy targets, while minimising, where possible, the impact on national carbon emissions.

In recent years, there has been a step-change in electricity demand growth driven by LEUs, largely driven by the increase in data centre developments. Ireland's total electricity demand has grown by 30% over the past 10 years, with data centre demand having greatly contributed to this level of growth. Accordingly, new data centres connecting under this policy will be required to provide new renewable and dispatchable electricity generation. The additional investment associated with these projects will help to address renewable energy targets and security of supply in the context of the additional demand associated with new data centres.

This decision paper set out the CRU's decisions in relation to the LEUs connection policy review and included a new direction to the electricity SOs under Section 34 of the 1999 Electricity Regulation Act. This direction supersedes Direction CRU/21/124 and will apply to all new connection applications for new or additional capacity captured under the scope of the decision.

1.9 Smart Meter Data Access Code Decision

To date, the National Smart Metering Programme (NSMP) has facilitated the nation-wide installation of more than 2.1 million smart meters. The new technology installed in smart meters allows for information on customers usage of electricity to be sent electronically from the smart meter to their respective electricity supplier and their actual electricity consumption is used to calculate their bill. This information is referred to as smart meter data.

The CRU published its decision on the Smart Meter Data Access Code (SMDAC) on the 19th February 2025. This sets out how parties can access the data collected by smart meters and the rules around that access in addition to the CRU's approach to governing the collection, retention, and utilisation of smart meter data. The introduction of the SMDAC will ensure that smart meter data is handled in an appropriate way, in accordance with all relevant data protection legislation. Suppliers and others must comply with the rules set out in the SMDAC and their obligations under data protection regulations before they can access smart meter data.

Ultimately, the SMDAC will enable suppliers and others to deliver value to customers through the development and introduction of new smart services and products. The provision of smart meter data will create opportunities to offer additional services to customers, such as more accurate and personalised price comparisons, better tailored tariffs, and analysis of customers' energy consumption. In addition, the provision of smart meter data under the SMDAC will also support the operation of the electricity network, helping Ireland to meet its climate action targets. It seeks

to inform stakeholders of CRU's approach and discusses and considers the responses received to the consultation which closed in October 2024.

The publication of the CRU's final decision and the SMDAC was the first step in a larger process involving the drafting of additional supporting documentation to facilitate the implementation of the SMDAC.

1.10 ESN Demand Flexibility Product

Following the CRU's Decision in May 2025 (CRU2025606) to approve the progression to the next stage of procurement, ESN has continued the development of the Demand Flexibility Product (DFP) and launched the first phase of procurement. In this phase ESN are aiming to contract up to 109MW of capacity across 16 locations. At the time of publication, bids in response to the tender have been reviewed, a value for money assessment has been completed, and ESN are due to announce the outcome of the procurement in the near term. While delivery timelines have been revised to reflect practical constraints, the programme has transitioned from concept development to execution phase, with procurement outcomes expected to underpin the future phases of procurement.

1.11 EirGrid Long Duration Energy Storage (LDES) Development

Long duration energy storage (LDES) procurement in Ireland is being progressed by EirGrid to support the delivery of increased system flexibility and security as renewable penetration grows. The objective is to procure storage assets with extended duration (typically ≥ 4 hours) capable of shifting energy across time, reducing curtailment and redispatch, and providing system support services during periods of low renewable output.

Since the previous NEDS biannual update, progress has advanced from early-stage options development to formal procurement design and consultation. Initial Call for Evidence work undertaken in 2023 and policy direction set through the 2024 Electricity Storage Policy Framework (including a mandate to procure up to 500 MW of LDES) have been followed by publication of an LDES procurement consultation in October 2025 and ongoing development of contract and evaluation frameworks throughout 2026. This reflects a transition from policy development to delivery phase, with the first procurement round expected to launch in 2027 and initial assets targeted to be operational by 2030.

2.ACER Demand Flexibility Related Updates

2.1 Flexibility Needs Assessment

The CRU has commenced Ireland's first National Flexibility Needs Assessment (FNA), a new EU-mandated process to understand how much electricity system flexibility Ireland will need, where it will be needed, and when, as the system transitions to high levels of renewable generation. The FNA covers both system-wide needs and local network needs on the transmission and distribution networks. It is being delivered in collaboration with EirGrid and ESNB, using a common methodology approved by ACER to ensure consistency across Europe. The findings will help inform the setting of Ireland's national non-fossil flexibility targets, support more efficient planning for renewable integration, guide future flexibility procurement frameworks, and support security of supply objectives.

Progress has been made to date on the FNA, with the scope of the data and modelling agreed and detailed analysis currently underway by the SOs, targeting the delivery of Ireland's first FNA report in Q3 2026. Alongside technical modelling, the FNA also includes a joint assessment of market barriers to flexibility, examining whether current market arrangements, signals and regulations enable flexibility to come forward where it is most valuable. This work will identify where barriers exist, where they are already being addressed, and where further policy or regulatory action may be required to help enable flexibility needs to be met efficiently by the market.

2.2 Demand Response

Previously, ACER initiated a consultation process and engaged with stakeholders on the proposed EU-wide network code on demand response (DRNC). The CRU, along with other National Regulatory Authorities (NRAs), contributed input throughout this engagement, which was then submitted by ACER to the EC on the 7th March 2025 for comitology (the process by which the EC implements EU law with the assistance of committees composed of national representatives). Formal adoption via comitology is expected during 2026. The scope of the Code includes rules to enable demand-side flexibility to participate in electricity markets on a non-discriminatory and technology-neutral basis, including through aggregation, market access, coordination with SOs and principles for market-based procurement, and therefore aligns with the objective of NEDS to enable growth of flexibility. The CRU is currently planning the implementation of the Code, pending the outcomes of the comitology process, and will continue to monitor progress.

3.Upcoming milestones

- Flexibility Needs Assessment 2026 report is expected to be published in July 2026 to present the outcomes of the first implementation of the ACER methodology by ESNB and EirGrid.
- LDES Procurement Decision expected to be published in Q3 2026.
- Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 expected to be published in Q3 2026.

4.Relevant publications

The list below includes relevant publications subsequent to the previous NEDS Biannual Update in July 2025 (CRU202580). For previous publications, please refer to the previous NEDS updates (CRU202505 and CRU202580).

- DETE's Large Energy User Action Plan (LEAP), January 2026
- CRU's Conceptual Design for Energy Sharing and Multiple Supply Contracts - Call for Evidence (CRU2025261)
- CRU Large Energy Users Connection Policy – Decision Paper (CRU2025236)
- EirGrid LDES Procurement Mechanism Consultation, October 2025
- Electricity Network Tariff Structure Review: Project Re-start (CRU2025120)
- CRU National Energy Demand Strategy Biannual Update Q3 2025 (CRU202580)

5.NEDS Actions Update

Action No.	Action Title and Description	Responsible body (Supporting body)	Completion Date	Progress	Update
Overall Strategy					
0.1	Governance arrangements for NEDS implementation Develop and agree governance Terms of Reference and maintain dialogue on enduring governance for NEDS. Hold associated meetings and engagements.	CRU (DCEE)	Q4 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	Governance Terms of Reference developed with key stakeholders. Relevant engagements ongoing.
0.2	Review the impact of NEDS on carbon emissions Establish a methodology and the potential emissions impact of NEDS.	CRU (EPA, SEAI, DCEE)	2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Following review, it was recommended that this action should be progressed as part of the next iteration of the NEDS, with assignment of this action to responsible bodies possessing the necessary authority and functions. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
0.3	NEDS progress reporting Publish progress reports. Reports will assess progress in three ways: by estimating flexibility delivered to the system from NEDS initiatives, tracking progress of actions, and reviewing the impact of NEDS initiatives on carbon emissions.	CRU (SOs, EPA, SEAI, DCEE)	2026	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	The NEDS update publication transitioned to an annual publication. Accordingly, a third NEDS update is being published in June'26 (CRU202628). A separate Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 publication (CRU202629) is expected to be published in Q3 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

⁴ Where actions are indicated as having been “completed”, the corresponding NEDS Biannual/Annual Update is provided (where the completion status has been achieved). Note that there may be some difference between the specific date on when the action was actually completed, in comparison to the quarter for which the action is being reported as completed.

0.4	Develop NEDS Communications Strategy Develop a communications strategy for the overall NEDS.	CRU (DCEE, DETE, ESBN, EirGrid, GNI, SEAI, IDA)	Q4 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	A NEDS Communications Strategy has been developed to facilitate the coordination and aligned dissemination of messaging on relevant NEDS activities across the relevant stakeholders. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
0.5	Publish NEDS strategy update Develop and iterate strategy to reflect progress of initiatives and new information. Decision document for following period of NEDS delivery published.	CRU (DCEE, DETE, State Agencies)	2026/2027	Due to commence	The CRU have commenced gathering learning and feedback both from the impact of the NEDS actions together, and via submissions received from stakeholders to the online NEDS Review Survey in Feb'26. These can be taken into consideration in the development of the next iteration of the NEDS. However, the CRU do not have capacity to lead or coordinate cross-Government work on the next iteration of the NEDS. Furthermore, an all-of-Government approach will be essential to deliver the next iteration of the NEDS. The objectives, challenges and activities required for a robust demand strategy extend well beyond the CRU's regulatory remit, and effective coordination will require leadership and engagement across multiple departments and agencies. CRU is engaging with DCEE in relation to this action.
Area 1A: Smart Services – Retail, Products and Incentives					
1.1	ToU tariffs Increase the number of permitted ToU tariffs offered and address barriers and incentives to increase uptake across customers.	Energy suppliers (CRU)	2026	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Energy suppliers - since 2025 - have been free to offer customers up to eight ToU tariffs, increased from six. Uptake barriers have been addressed by targeted price incentivisation and increased diversification of tariff products favouring ToU participation and active customer engagement, resulting in a measurable increase in customer uptake across the supplier base. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

1.2	Dynamic tariffs Develop and offer dynamic tariffs to customers following decision requiring suppliers with more than 200,000 final customers to have dynamic tariffs in place.	Energy suppliers (CRU)	Q3 2025 Q2 2026 ⁵	On Track	In response to a request received by the CRU from suppliers, the CRU extended the deadline by which suppliers must bring dynamic tariffs to the market from 01/10/25 to 01/06/26. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q3 2025 to Q2 2026 to account for the delay arising from this extended deadline materially impacting the completion of this action.
1.3	Smart EV charging services Engage across relevant parties to develop propositions for smart charging services, including an exploratory investigation of vehicle-to-grid (V2G) services. Establish working group to explore barriers and enablers. Publish programme of work.	ESBN (CRU, Energy suppliers, ZEVI, EirGrid)	Q4 2025 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	Exploratory investigation into vehicle-to-grid (V2G) services was completed, with a relevant report issued to the CRU in September 2025 (See also NEDS Action 2.17). Engagement continues between ESBN and the CRU on the establishment of a working group to explore barriers and enablers, after which a programme of work can be published. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q4 2025 to Q3 2026 to account for the delay arising from external dependencies materially impacting the completion of this action.
1.4	Review of policy & supports for EV charging Review measures that support EV charging with a view to identifying how they can better support flexibility. This should include a review of depot charging for Heavy Duty Vehicles to consider how this type of charging can support flexibility potential.	ZEVI (SEAI, CRU)	Q1 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	Internal review is now completed which will inform the next iteration of the National EV Infrastructure Strategy. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

⁵ The completion date for the action is subject to change as the action has been identified as eligible for re-baselining due to external dependencies, availability of resources or the prioritisation of the action.

1.5	Price Comparison Website accreditation Consult on the Price Comparison Website Accreditation Framework.	CRU	Q4 2024	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	CRU published consultation on a review of the PCW Accreditation Framework in May 2025 [CRU/202566] See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
1.6	Customer engagement for flexibility initiatives Develop, agree and publish plan for customer (residential & businesses) engagement to drive widespread awareness, consumer interest and desire to participate in flexibility initiatives.	Smart Energy Services Working Group (Energy suppliers, DCEE, CRU, SEAI, ESBN, EirGrid)	Q1 2025 2026 - 2028 ⁵	On Track	Following a pause in its operation, and the consideration of Smart Energy Policy by the newly established National Energy Affordability Taskforce, the Smart Energy Services Working Group is due to be reconvened in Q3 2026 with a view to progressing the delivery of this action. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q1 2025 to 2026 - 2028 to account for the delay arising from external dependencies materially impacting the completion of this action.
1.7	Flexibility benefits and opportunities for businesses Develop an approach for active engagement with businesses to raise awareness of information about the opportunities for companies to participate in and benefit from flexibility as appropriate to existing programmes (e.g. support schemes, financial/carbon savings).	SEAI (CRU, DETE, IDA, Enterprise Ireland, Energy suppliers)	Q3 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	The smart and flexible energy hub is live on the SEAI website (link) with a dedicated section for businesses, providing information, education and awareness for smart and flexible opportunities for businesses. The SEAI will continue to update and evolve this hub on an ongoing basis to adequately meet the needs of a rapidly changing sector.
1.8	Tariffs for business Undertake market testing, research and trials to enable tariffs most suited to businesses' demand profiles to be developed.	Energy suppliers (CRU)	Q3 2025	Completed ⁴ (Q2 2026)	Energy suppliers have reported having undertaken market testing and research with commercial customers to develop smart tariff products and economic incentives based on the identified businesses' demand profile. The objective of developing load-reflective commercial tariff products has been achieved by increased commercial awareness and rewards for energy efficiency and demand-shifting behaviour. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

Area 1B: Smart Services – Infrastructure and Systems					
1.9	Completion of smart meter rollout Smart meter upgrades to continue across remaining domestic customers including day/night meters. Complete rollout of smart meters for 3 Phase customers. Develop and adapt delivery to maximise the benefits of smart meters.	ESBN (CRU)	2026	On Track	In August 2025, ESBN achieved the major milestone of 2 million installations and has commenced the exchange of 3-phase whole current meters.
1.10	Communication system for system alerts Review communication system that notifies relevant system users (such as suppliers and LEUs) in advance of a system alert and a low system non-synchronous penetration (SNSP) event.	EirGrid	Q4 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	Report submitted to the CRU (Q1 2025). See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
1.11A	Microgeneration operational issues Review impact of operational challenges for System Operators associated with high levels of microgeneration given the potential growth of installations and report to the CRU.	ESBN (CRU)	Q2 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	A report on the operational impacts of microgeneration on system operators was completed and provided to the CRU in June 2025. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
1.11B	Microgeneration operational issues Review impact of operational challenges for System Operators associated with high levels of microgeneration given the potential growth of installations and report to the CRU.	EirGrid (CRU)	Q2 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	A report was compiled, detailing the challenges facing the TSO, along with potential mitigations and recommendations. ESBN and EirGrids' reports were consolidated and submitted to the CRU in Q2 2025. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

1.12	Market design changes for secondary measurement devices Consultation to establish what market design changes will be required for secondary measurement devices, and the timelines for implementing those changes.	CRU (ESBN, EirGrid)	2026	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	CRU published a call for evidence paper (CRU2025261) in January 2026. In this paper, the CRU has set out initial considerations or potential high-level solutions for energy sharing and multiple supply contracts and the enabling role of the secondary measurement devices. The purpose of the paper was to engage stakeholders at an early stage in the policy development cycle, raising awareness of this area and seeking feedback. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
Area 1C: Smart Services – Business Models					
1.13	Licences for aggregation and demand response Consult on development of new licences for aggregation and demand response.	CRU	2025 2028 ⁵	Due to Commence	A delay in progressing this action has been incurred due to a lack of resources. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2025 to 2028 to account for limited resources materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
1.14	Regulatory framework for “Relevant Market Participants” Consult on a regulatory framework for “Relevant Market Participants”, which is a market participant that is not a licensed electricity undertaking, to support emerging and innovative business models.	CRU	2025 2027 - 2030 ⁵	On Track	The CRU is currently undertaking a review of the legal framework underpinning Relevant Market Participants prior to commencing a consultation process. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2025 to 2027 – 2030 to account for a wider delay arising from insufficient resources and the need for reprioritisation in order to progress and complete this action.
1.15	Energy sharing and trading Publish call for evidence in relation to energy sharing to identify and develop opportunities to support producers and consumers to share their generated electricity and incentivise flexibility.	CRU (ESBN, EirGrid)	2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	CRU published a call for evidence paper (CRU2025261) in January 2026. In this paper, the CRU has set out initial considerations or potential high-level solutions for energy sharing and multiple supply contracts. The purpose of the paper was to engage stakeholders at an early stage in the policy development cycle, raising awareness of this area and seeking feedback. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

Area 1D: Smart Services – Standards and Interoperability					
1.16	‘Flexibility readiness’ requirements Introduce technical requirements for interoperable telecommunications and control facilities for inverter interfaced small scale solar PV and battery sources.	ESBN (Smart Energy Services Working Group, SEAI, CRU)	Q3 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Whilst progress has been maintained on this action, its completion was delayed beyond the agreed date. Briefing provided to ESBNs’ external stakeholders and supporting bodies at ESBNs’ Advisory Council in Q4 2025. The final ESNB report outlining the key findings and recommendations was submitted to the CRU in May 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
1.17	Energy smart appliances Publish review of options for development of standards to enable the uptake of “energy smart” appliances.	Smart Energy Services Working Group (DCEE, NSAI, DETE, CRU, ESNB)	Q3 2025 2026 - 2028 ⁵	On Track	Following a pause in its operation, and the consideration of Smart Energy Policy by the newly established National Energy Affordability Taskforce, the Smart Energy Services Working Group is due to be reconvened in Q3 2026 with a view to progressing the delivery of this action. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q1 2025 to 2026 - 2028 to account for the delay arising from external dependencies materially impacting the completion of this action.
1.18	Smart Meter Data Access Code Publish decision on the Smart Meter Data Access Code to determine how smart meter data can be accessed by market participants and third parties	CRU (ESBN, Energy suppliers)	Q3 2024	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	The CRU published its decision on the Smart Meter Data Access Code (CRU202517) on the 19th February 2025. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
Area 2A: Demand Flexibility & Response – Market Frameworks					
2.1	Electricity network tariff reform Commence project to assess options for reform of electricity network tariffs and charging, addressing priority areas for delivery that have emerged through the NEDS process including treatment of storage, and fixed and volumetric allocations.	CRU	Q2 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Following the Request for Tender that closed on October 2025, external consultant support commenced on the project on 27th February 2026. Ongoing work now builds on the insights received in response to the Information paper published advising stakeholders of the project re-start, outline of Phase 1 and request for supplemental input (CRU/2025/120), which closed in October 2025 and received 30 responses. The CRU are progressing work

					with a view to publishing a consultation on the scope of the ENTSR in 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.2	V2G charging point uptake Review how support for the increased uptake of V2G-enabled charging points can be implemented as part of the Electric Vehicle Charging Strategy 2026 – 2029 and reflect this updated strategy publication.	ZEVI (CRU, ESBN, Charging Point Operators)	Q4 2025 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	The draft National EV Charging Infrastructure Strategy 2026-2028 was published for consultation (26th February to 24th April 2026). Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q4 2025 to Q3 2026 to account for a delay experienced arising from external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
2.3	Increase flexibility provided by DSUs Develop and publish a plan of work to improve active participation and performance of DSUs in the market and remove barriers. Plan to clarify expectations on DSUs to increase the flexibility, consider industry-suggested code changes and describe technical updates to be implemented for TSO and MO systems.	EirGrid (DSUs, Suppliers, ESBN, CRU)	Q1 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	TSO Demand Side White Paper was published on EirGrid and SONI websites. A TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan, which will include the elements in this action, has been drafted. The actions required to improve active participation and performance of DSUs in the market were identified and consolidated in a high-level report. This report was published on EirGrid's website in July 2025: link See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.4	Market changes to enable increased flexibility Assess and report on status and potential solutions to enable energy market participants to offer increased flexibility through the energy market, supporting more flexible trading of demand, engaging suppliers more actively, and ensuring technology neutrality in market and dispatch systems.	EirGrid (CRU, ESBN, Market participants)	Q2 2025 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	A draft of the TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan, which will include the elements required by this action, is currently being developed and discussed in bi-weekly engagement with the CRU. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q2 2025 to Q3 2026 to account for a delay experienced arising from external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.

Area 2B: Demand Flexibility & Response – Procurement and product development					
2.5	Long Duration Energy Storage Develop detailed procurement options informed by Call for Evidence responses and report to the CRU. Consultation paper to follow (Q4 2024).	EirGrid (CRU, DCEE)	Q3 2024	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Consultation published in October 2025 link . Response paper underway with continued engagement with CRU. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.6	TSO demand flexibility product EirGrid to keep under review further potential options for TSO demand flexibility products, reporting output to CRU.	EirGrid (CRU)	2025 Q4 2026 ⁵	On Track	Work has started through initial scoping and research, and some of the initial ideas have been raised by the TSO in the recently started bi-weekly engagement with the CRU. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2025 to Q4 2026 to account for a delay experienced arising from external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
2.7	Maximum Import Capacity flexibility ESBN to review opportunity to deliver flexibility through Maximum Import Capacity on distribution system connection agreements and engage with the CRU.	ESBN (CRU, EirGrid)	Q1 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	Review of opportunities complete and submitted to CRU in June 2025. Overview provided to NEDS Implementation Group in June 2025. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

2.8	Flexibility Needs Assessment Undertake and publish assessment of flexibility needs in line with ACER flexibility-needs assessment methodology, and other relevant considerations (e.g. the assessment of EV recharging points operation & potential contribution, Alternative Fuels Infrastructure Regulation - Articles 15 (3) and (4)). Engage with fellow regulators via ACER and CEER to maximise learning from others, and to influence direction of flexibility market design across the EU.	CRU (EirGrid, ESBN)	Q2 2026 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	The CRU has developed a plan for the completion of the Flexibility Needs Assessment and engaged with the SO on the implementation of the ACER methodology. EirGrid and ESBN have initiated relevant assessments in line with FNA methodology, and the CRU has developed a draft report structure. The direction for FNA implementation was issued in Nov'25 and publication of the report is planned for July'26. As requested by DCEE, the CRU engaged with ESBN, EirGrid, and ZEVl to gather the necessary evidence and input for reporting on requirements as set out in AFIR articles 15(3) and 15(4). The resulting report was published in May 2026. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q2 2026 to Q3 2026 to account for a minor delay experienced arising from external ACER related dependencies materially impacting the progress and overall completion of this action.
2.9	Flexibility market development In update to flexibility multi-year plan set out plan for longer term ambition to move from focused product development to broader technology and sector agnostic arrangements to build a deep and competitive market.	ESBN	Q4 2025 Q4 2026 ⁵	On Track	Work is currently under review to take account of external policy developments which could materially impact ESBN's Flexibility market development plans e.g. Network Code for Demand Response. ESBN intends to engage closely over the coming months with CRU on the further development of this action taking account of latest policy developments. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q4 2025 to Q4 2026 to account for external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.

2.10	DSO demand flexibility product Review further potential options for DSO demand flexibility products including industrial heat.	ESBN (CRU, DETE, Enterprise Ireland)	Q1 2025	Completed (Q3 2025) ⁴	Reviewed a range of existing and new products that enable flexibility participation across various market segments. Engaged with supporting bodies and review submitted to CRU in May 2025. Overview also provided to NEDS Implementation Group in June 2025. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.11	DSO flexibility procurement Second stage consultation on detailed aspects of product design to support medium-duration flexibility procurement tender process.	ESBN (CRU)	Q3 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	Second stage consultation on the Demand Flexibility Product (CRU202560) closed on the 9 th December 2024. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.12	Biomethane lighthouse Publish plan to deliver biomethane lighthouse project, including indication of anticipated biomethane volumes and further details (e.g. imported or domestic, if via Guarantees of Origin, etc.) to deliver flexibility.	ESBN (CRU, GNI, Biomethane Implementation Group)	Q4 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	Expression of interest published in November 2024 (link). Engagement complete with supporting bodies on the project plan. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.13	Smart charging flexibility product Develop and launch new smart charging flexibility product and/or service and ensure the delivery is fair and effective in enabling demand flexibility through EVs.	ESBN (CRU, Suppliers)	Q4 2025 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	While progress has been maintained on this action, its completion has been delayed due to a dependency upon vendor engagement which is currently ongoing. A vendor has been selected, and contracting is in its final stages, ahead of a planned EV Flex Pilot launch by Q3 2026. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q4 2025 to Q3 2026 to account for external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
2.14	Gas flexibility products & services Undertake assessment to identify flexibility products & services on the gas network which can contribute towards achieving targets and overall NEDS objectives (Ref: Energy Security Package Action 4).	GNI (CRU)	2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	GNI supported the CRU in the development of a consultation paper on an Interruptible Capacity Gas Product, the publication of which is imminent in Q2 2026.

Area 2C: Demand Flexibility & Response – Technology, Platforms and Systems					
2.15	European SCALE project monitoring Monitor relevant developments from the Smart Charging Alignment for Europe (SCALE) project and reflect learnings in updated NEDS strategy.	CRU	2026	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Ongoing monitoring has been established with relevant learnings/input to be fed into an updated NEDS and other workstreams as appropriate. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.16	Optimise EV fleet charging Develop and publish plan to optimise EV fleet charging through technology and software solutions.	ESBN (Aggregators of EVs, Suppliers, CRU, ZEVI)	Q2 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	A final report was issued to the CRU in September 2025. ESNB will publish the report on the ESNB website as part of the refresh of ESNBs' DMSO Blueprint and Roadmaps, which ESNB expects to conclude in H2 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.17	Smart EV charging availability Develop and publish technical assessment of how the available smart EV charging and V2G capacity can be maximised through network operations.	ESBN (CPOs, ZEVI, large EV fleet owners/operators and Local Authorities)	Q2 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	A final report was issued to the CRU in September 2025. ESNB will publish the report on the ESNB website as part of the refresh of ESNBs' DMSO Blueprint and Roadmaps, which ESNB expects to conclude in H2 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.18	Changes required for dispatchable consumption Implement code and system changes to better accommodate "dispatchable consumption" proposals and upwards demand response.	EirGrid	2027-2029 ⁵	On Track	Implementation has been realigned to reflect wider system changes, as well as market design dependencies. High level and detailed requirements were completed in 2025, with Trading and Settlement Code changes scheduled to begin in 2026, ahead of detailed system design and implementation. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2027 to 2029 to account for developments materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.

Area 2D: Demand Flexibility & Response – Information, Certification and Reporting					
2.19	Electricity system emissions information Review approach to reporting of real time emissions from TSO dispatch of the system engaging with the CRU. Develop approach to integrate emissions data and reporting into wider TSO decision-making where it is possible to do so.	EirGrid (CRU, ESBN, SEAI)	2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	Full report was drafted by EirGrid and shared with the CRU for final approval in May 2026. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.20	Gas network emissions information Explore and implement potential enhancements to the information available on system emissions, drawing on international examples and engaging the CRU.	GNI (CRU)	Q4 2024 Q3 2026 ⁵	On Track	A web-based solution has been developed and is now being tested before deployment on the GNI website. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from Q4 2024 to Q3 2026 to account for internal procedural dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
2.21	Enhanced emissions reporting framework (Part 1) Deliver the design report for an enhanced emissions reporting framework for electricity emissions for LEUs (CAP24 action: EL/24/22).	SEAI (CRU, EirGrid, ESBN, Enterprise Agencies)	Q3 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	The SEAI's LEU electricity emissions reporting framework published in December 2024 (link).
2.22	Electricity Guarantees of Origin Review data on Guarantees of Origin including information currently used by suppliers for fuel mix disclosure, and identify design options for more detailed certification implementation. (Linked to 2.21)	CRU (SEMO)	Q4 2024	Completed (Q1 2025) ⁴	Reviewed the design options for more detailed reporting on GOs in the annual FMD Reporting with SEMO in Q4 2024, followed by discussions on data availability and final output of design options in Q2 2025. It was decided to retain the current structure of the FMD Annual Report at present and await EU guidelines on granular GOs. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.

2.23	Certification of additionality for (a) power and (b) renewable gas Explore the potential offered by new structured power products in the market and review options for certification of additionality for (a) power (CRU, EirGrid) and (b) renewable gas (CRU, GNI). Review and consult subject to initial assessment. (Linked to 2.22)	CRU (EirGrid, GNI)	Q2 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	An initial assessment conducted by the CRU indicated there is no consistent definition of additionality for power, unlike the additionality of gas (as Article 5 of Delegated EU Regulation (2023/1184), supplementing Directive (EU) 2018/2001) and hence no real opportunity to demonstrate additionality for renewable generation at present. A definition and associated policy for the additionality of power need to be set out by Government to lay the foundation for new (additional energy certification) power products to demonstrate additionality. See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
2.24	Future role of the gas network Ensure a fit for purpose gas grid, that supports Ireland's energy and climate ambition. Includes the development of scenarios to define the future role of the gas network. (Ref: Energy Security Package Action 16) ⁶⁷	GNI (DCEE, CRU)	2024 – 2025 2026 - 2030 ⁵	On Track	There are common themes and requirements between Action 2.24 and Action 2.25. Work has progressed to map the deliverables across Actions 2.24, 2.25 and PC5 reporting, including consideration of overlaps and interdependencies. GNI has also advanced work on energy system modelling. Reflecting external dependencies, including the Energy Security Package, the National Hydrogen Strategy and the SEAI Decarbonised Electricity System Study, revised timelines are being applied. Consistent with this, these actions are expected to be reviewed as part of the development of NEDS 2.0. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2024 – 2025 to 2026 - 2030 to account for external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.

2.25	Support planning for the future role of the gas network and pathway for implementation Develop a plan for transitioning the gas network over time, taking due consideration of various aspects including development of the hydrogen and biomethane sectors, energy security, costs, blending, amongst others. (Ref: National Hydrogen Strategy Action 12)	GNI (DCEE, CRU)	2023—2026 2026 – 2030 ⁵	On Track	There are common themes and requirements between Action 2.24 and Action 2.25 relating to the future role of the gas network and hydrogen readiness. Progress has been made on technical benchmarking, development of a hydrogen roadmap and ongoing asset readiness assessments. However, delivery timelines are influenced by external dependencies, including UK hydrogen blending policy, the Energy Security Package, the National Hydrogen Strategy and completion of the SEAI Decarbonised Electricity System Study. In light of these dependencies, revised timelines are being reflected and it is anticipated that these actions will be reviewed as part of NEDS 2.0. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2023 – 2026 to 2026 - 2030 to account for external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
Area 3: New Demand Connections					
3.1	Publication of new LEU connection policy (a) Publish the next stage of consultation. (b) Publish and implement new connection policy for LEUs.	CRU	a) Q3 2024 b) 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	a) Proposed Decision published in February 2025 (CRU202504) b) LEUs Connection Policy Decision published in December 2025 (CRU2025236).

3.2A	Enhanced quality and accessibility of network information Enhance quality and accessibility of information relating to areas of the network, where capacity is available and future network development plans.	ESBN (CRU)	2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	The CRU published a decision (CRU202504) which requires the SOs to publish regular up to date locational information (existing and outlook) in relation to the availability of capacity on the electricity network and network constraint. The format of this will be determined through further engagement between the CRU and the SOs. In 2025, ESBN has published new capacity heatmaps, capacity workbooks, and the Distribution Network Development Plan (DNDP) on their website See Appendix for supplementary close-out information.
3.2B	Enhanced quality and accessibility of network information Enhance quality and accessibility of information relating to areas of the network, where capacity is available and future network development plans.	EirGrid (CRU)	2025 Q2 2026 ⁵	On Track	Development of the report on the approach to improving network information is underway, and a draft is expected to be available for CRU review in June 2026. Following the rebaselining review, the completion date for this action has been updated from 2025 to Q2 2026 to account for external dependencies materially impacting the progress and completion of this action.
3.3	Monitor work being undertaken to assess the role that integrated energy parks could play in our future energy system Monitor work being undertaken as part of the National Hydrogen Strategy to assess the role that integrated energy parks could play in our future energy system, including their potential benefits and the possible barriers (market, legal or other) that may exist. (Ref: National Hydrogen Strategy Action 6)	CRU (DCEE, DETE, IDA, ESBN, EirGrid, GNI)	Q4 2025	Completed (Q2 2026) ⁴	The CRU has been engaging with the relevant Government Departments in relation to the development of Green Energy Park concepts and the Large Energy User Action Plan (LEAP) which was published in January 2026 (LEAP – Large Energy User Action Plan - DETE).

6. Next Steps

The NEDS remains in its current implementation phase, with this publication representing the third update in the series. One further update is expected, which will provide a final consolidated position on delivery and support the **close-out of this phase of the strategy**.

Significant progress has been made to date in advancing the delivery of NEDS actions and establishing the key building blocks required to enable demand-side flexibility. As implementation has progressed, the delivery environment has become increasingly complex, reflecting growing interdependencies with wider Government policy, infrastructure planning, and evolving European frameworks.

In the period ahead, the CRU will continue to:

- **Monitor and report on progress** against NEDS actions, including through the final planned update in this series;
- **Publish the Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026: NEDS Action 0.3 (CRU202629)**, providing an updated estimate of demand-side flexibility and the underlying methodology;
- **Engage with Government Departments, SOs, and other stakeholders**, to reflect implementation experience and emerging developments across the energy system;
- **Support consideration of relevant EU developments**, including the FNA and DRNC, as these progress.

As set out in this update, a number of factors are shaping the delivery context for NEDS actions, including increasing demand growth, particularly from LEUs, and the continued development of national and European policy frameworks. These developments highlight the importance of **ongoing coordination across relevant bodies**, particularly where delivery relies on interactions between policy, regulatory, and operational functions.

Looking beyond the current implementation phase, it is recognised that the **next iteration of the NEDS will require a broader governance model**, reflecting the fact that many of the key levers for enabling demand flexibility sit beyond the CRU's regulatory remit. The development of a future strategy will therefore require **cross-government ownership**, with clearly defined roles, responsibilities, and coordination mechanisms across relevant departments and agencies. The CRU will continue to contribute its experience and insights from the delivery of the NEDS to inform this evolving discussion.

In parallel, key areas of focus for the remainder of this implementation phase include:

- **Ensuring the delivery of remaining NEDS actions** in line with revised timelines;
- **Advancing key enabling measures**, including tariff development, flexibility procurement, and customer participation;
- **Maintaining visibility of dependencies and interactions** across related programmes and policy initiatives.

Overall, the focus for the next phase may increasingly involve moving from the **delivery of individual actions** towards achieving **measurable flexibility outcomes at a system level**, ensuring that Ireland's energy demand can respond effectively to increasing renewable generation and evolving system needs.

The CRU welcomes feedback (energydemandstrategy@cru.ie) in relation to the information set out in this NEDS Annual Update publication, or any topics relevant to the overall strategy.

Appendix A – Supplementary information for completed NEDS actions

For completed NEDS actions where the output has resulted in a published document, a link is provided in the relevant action update text (see Section 5). The objective of this section is to provide an overview of NEDS actions that have been completed, but where the output has not resulted in a publicly available report, publication, or closing document.

As such, this section contains further information in relation to actions which have been completed during the current reporting period for this NEDS update (which covers the period from July 2025 to May 2026). It also includes actions which were completed in a previous reporting period, but a summary of which was not included previously. In addition, and only in certain circumstances, a closing summary may also be provided for an Action that did result in a publicly available document if it has been deemed necessary to do so for action delivery completeness purposes.

A.1 NEDS Action 0.2: Review the impact of NEDS on carbon emissions (CRU)

Following the completion of an initial scoping review, an information gathering approach was adopted to determine how best to adequately assess the effect of demand-side flexibility on grid carbon emissions and the contribution of NEDS actions.

The CRU engaged firstly with MaREI where a qualitative and quantitative approach to account for indirect and enabling NEDS actions was discussed. Thereafter, the CRU engaged with DCEE and DETE where it was suggested that actions should be grouped by sector and compared to existing reporting frameworks as existing approaches to measuring carbon emissions (e.g. for CAP reporting) might not be sufficiently granular in order to adequately demonstrate the impact from NEDS actions. Finally, the CRU engaged with the SEAI and the EPA to assess the existing availability of data and modelling capabilities in order to accurately quantify the impact of NEDS actions. This engagement firstly highlighted the importance of the need for counterfactual modelling against which all calculations can be compared i.e. to quantify what the carbon emissions would otherwise be in the absence of the NEDS actions. Secondly, it became clear that challenges currently exist preventing the attribution of a measured impact to a specific NEDS action plus the necessary accessibility to more granular data - while assistance would be forthcoming to aid in the assessment of emissions calculations in general, the necessary data required to drive this is not currently available.

In parallel, NEDS actions were reviewed and categorised to identify their potential impact on carbon emissions and relevance of the action to any such impact. For example: a direct change

in emissions as a result of the action (Scope 2 emissions), an indirect impact on emissions (e.g. reduction in electricity consumption that requires fossil fuel to generate), or an enabling impact for actions that facilitate other emission-impacting measures. Once these initial steps had been completed, the next stage of the approach would then consist of identifying an appropriate methodology for quantifying the impact of each action category with sufficient granularity to assess the impact on the grid carbon emissions.

The CRU's initial review concluded that available data and its granularity are currently not sufficient to enable the quantification of the impacts of NEDS actions on carbon emissions. In addition, having due regard to the requirements of Section 15 of the Climate Action and Low Carbon Development Act 2015 and the CRU's existing statutory functions, it is recommended that it would be more appropriate for this action to be progressed as part of the next iteration of the NEDS with a reassignment of the action to responsible bodies possessing the necessary authority and functions, aligning with the key recommendations for Government Departments as contained in the NEDS Decision.

Ultimately the next phase should focus on refining the CRU's initial approach, securing data access, and ensuring governance structures are in place to deliver a robust and transparent framework to enable the measurement of the carbon impact of NEDS actions into the future.

A.2 NEDS Action 0.3: NEDS progress reporting (CRU)

Since the NEDS decision was published in July 2024, the CRU will have published three NEDS updates in Q1 2025 (CRU202505), Q3 2025 (CRU202580) and this publication in Q2 2026 (CRU202628). Each update has provided a progress overview of NEDS actions. In addition, the CRU will be publishing a Demand Flexibility Forecasting Report 2026 - NEDS Action 0.3 (CRU202629) shortly after this update (as previously outlined in Section 1.7 of this publication).

A.3 NEDS Action 0.4: Develop NEDS Communications Strategy (CRU)

Following the publication of the NEDS decision in July 2024, Action 0.4 placed a responsibility on the CRU, together with the NEDS Implementation Group members, to develop a NEDS Communications Strategy. The objective of such a strategy was to facilitate the coordinated and aligned dissemination of NEDS messaging between the various stakeholders identified as having responsibility for and/or a supporting role in the completion of NEDS actions throughout the NEDS implementation phase.

The NEDS Communications Strategy that was developed was not intended to replace or supersede NEDS stakeholders' individual communications strategies. Instead, the primary objective was to establish complementary common principles and a framework for effective

communication and engagement on relevant or cross-cutting NEDS topics post publication of the decision. Effective engagement is vital to (a) build cooperation to deliver the objectives and NEDS actions, (b) further build common understanding, and (c) gather input and learn lessons to improve and refine the strategy or individual measures.

The NEDS Communications Strategy established three key outputs:

1. It outlines what successful communication and engagement for the NEDS looks like.
2. Specific communication and engagement actions have been agreed with key stakeholders.
3. A framework has been established to ensure effective communication and engagement post publication, and allows for regular updates to be made to stakeholders' communications and engagement.

A.4 NEDS Action 1.1: ToU tariffs (Energy Suppliers)

This action required the CRU to increase the number of ToU tariffs permitted to be offered by licensed electricity suppliers, and to address barriers and incentives to customer uptake. Action 1.1 is now complete, with evidence demonstrating that suppliers have been permitted to offer customers up to eight ToU tariffs (previously up to six), which provided suppliers with greater scope to design and offer differentiated products. Barriers and incentives to uptake have been addressed through product diversification across the supplier base, pricing differentials supporting customer migration to ToU products, incentive structures linked to broader smart energy participation, and sustained customer engagement activity. Supplier reports submitted to the CRU evidence a measurable increase in customer uptake of ToU tariffs over the period.

The CRU is informed on the offerings, products, incentives and uptake figures through supplier returns; these returns are commercially confidential and are not enumerated in this update.

A.5 NEDS Action 1.4: Review of policy & supports for EV charging (ZEVI)

Following a review of measures that support EV charging with a view to identifying how they can better support flexibility, which included a review of depot charging for Heavy Duty Vehicles, ZEVI introduced the Zero Emissions Heavy Duty Vehicles – Infrastructure (ZEHDV-I).

ZEHDV-I is an infrastructure grant scheme intended to assist the purchase and installation of depot charging infrastructure associated with the recharging of Heavy-Duty Vehicles (HDVs) that are electric and zero-emission. The infrastructure can be used solely for private use by the

applicant and/or made available to the public use and the grant amounts are calculated from the size of undertaking and percentage of eligible costs.

A.6 NEDS Action 1.5: Price Comparison Website Accreditation (CRU)

The CRU's Price Comparison Website (PCW) Accreditation framework provides a voluntary accreditation process whereby PCWs can become accredited by the CRU, provided they adhere to the principles of the framework. The framework ensures that customers can trust that the energy price comparison services provided by accredited websites are independent, transparent, and reliable.

Due to the legislative and retail market developments that have taken place since the last update of the framework in 2019, the CRU considered it appropriate to review the accreditation process. Accordingly, the CRU published a consultation on a review of the PCW Accreditation Framework in May 2025 [CRU/202566]. The updated framework aims to ensure that the accreditation process continues to work well now and, in the future. Accredited websites will continue to offer a service that is valuable for customers, one that is easy to use and understand as well as being trustworthy. Accredited PCWs will continue to help customers to choose the best tariffs available to them on the market.

A.7 NEDS Action 1.8: Dynamic tariffs

This action mandated suppliers to undertake market testing, research, and trials to enable the development of tariff products suited to business customer demand profiles. Commercial and industrial customers operate under load profiles materially distinct from domestic consumption, and tariff design for business customers must be evidence-based rather than adapted from the domestic tariff offering. Action 1.8 is now complete, with evidence showing that the majority of suppliers offer multiple tariff options tailored to the operational needs of different commercial and industrial customers and the required market testing, research, and trials have been undertaken by suppliers, with outputs informing the development of tailored business-segment tariff products now available to commercial and industrial customers. The developed products reflect segment-differentiated design, demand response elements, and design informed by commercial and industrial load profiles demonstrating that the intended market capability has been established. Suppliers have incorporated insights obtained from testing and trials into product design, and businesses now have access to tariff structures that are adapted to and better reflect their consumption patterns.

While the CRU has been privy to the market testing scope and emerging products through supplier reports, these returns are commercially confidential and are not enumerated in this update.

A.8 NEDS Action 1.10: Communication system for system alerts (EirGrid)

The purpose of this action was to review the communication system that notifies relevant system users, such as suppliers and LEUs, in advance of a system alert and a low system non-synchronous penetration event, and if required, implement additional communication process to new initiatives.

EirGrid reviewed the communications approaches, processes, and systems used to notify relevant system users of data and information about relevant system conditions, including new initiatives developed as part of the Security of Supply workstream. The communication system for system alerts report that EirGrid prepared considers the relationships between different initiatives and the relationship with system alert status conditions. The initiatives considered include System Margin Outlook, System Margin Message, and System Margin Warning, Voluntary Demand Reduction, Mandatory Demand Reduction, Public Appeal, Temporary Emergency Generation, Flexible Demand contracts for LEUs, pilots including Beat the Peak and Conservation Voltage Reduction, and Rota Demand Disconnection. They were considered in relation to their use at different system alert levels, primarily as required by the action considering the pre-alert communications required, but then also the processes followed through in system alert and system emergency conditions. The relevant communication details including the sources, target stakeholders, notice times, and channels in relation to these initiatives and the general communication of system alert status conditions were outlined. The locations of documentation and data sources for these processes and communications, and the data and information in relation to System Non-Synchronous Penetration (SNSP) conditions, were also outlined. This report was submitted to the CRU in December 2024.

Closing the report EirGrid concluded that the communications system and processes for making data and information available to relevant system users on system conditions, including system alerts, low margins, and low SNSP periods, are already operating and working suitably well. The report highlighted areas where further improvement could be made and the CRU will engage with EirGrid on the next steps arising from consideration of the report.

A.9 NEDS Action 1.11 A&B: Microgeneration Operational Issues (ESBN & EirGrid)

Action 1.11 requires ESBN and EirGrid to review the impact of operational challenges for SOs associated with high levels of microgeneration given the potential growth of installed capacity within this category over the short to medium term.

Both ESBN and EirGrid included a joint task under the Joint System Operator Programme, and this task was included in the Joint System Operator Programme Multi-Year Plan 2025-2029. Engagement between SOs and tracking of action progress was advanced via the Joint System Operator Programme governance arrangements.

ESBN and EirGrid have reviewed reported impacts from other jurisdictions (EU, USA and Australia), consulted with internal stakeholders to assess the local impact, and presented actions for mitigating the risks associated with high levels of micro-generation connecting to the distribution system.

The report provides an assessment of the impact of increasing penetration of micro-generation, focusing on system security, operational constraints, and the evolving challenges for both SOs, given the limited visibility and controllability of these resources. It also outlines mitigation strategies and regulatory pathways to ensure secure and efficient integration of large volumes of micro-generation.

A.10 NEDS Actions 1.12 and 1.15: Market design changes for secondary measurement devices and Energy sharing and trading (CRU)

A single closing summary is being provided for both NEDS Actions 1.12 and 1.15 as the delivery of both actions has been addressed within one CRU publication. The rollout of smart meters and the availability of more granular metering data facilitate new services for customers. The CRU published a call for evidence paper in January 2026 (CRU2025261), setting out the CRU's conceptual design for energy sharing and multiple suppliers. Energy sharing refers to active customers allocating their exported renewable energy to another customer and multiple supply contracts means that a customer can have more than one supply contract at a time at a single premises. Multiple suppliers means that a customer can have more than one supply contract at a time at a single premises.

In the call for evidence paper, the CRU set out initial considerations or potential high-level solutions for energy sharing and multiple supply contracts, and the enabling role of secondary measurement devices. The purpose of this paper was to engage stakeholders at an early stage in the policy development cycle, raising awareness of this area and seeking feedback. The comments and views expressed will aid the CRU in forming future positions in relation to the approach and development of a regulatory framework that will support their implementation. Once Directive 2024/1711 is transposed into Irish legislation, which aims to improve the EU's electricity market design by amending Directives (EU) 2018/2001 and (EU) 2019/944, the CRU expect to conduct further rounds of engagement. These are likely to involve more detailed proposals around how the solutions for energy sharing and multiple supply contracts will be delivered.

A.11 NEDS Action 1.16: “Flexibility readiness” requirements (ESBN)

The objective of NEDS Action 1.16 is to introduce technical requirements for interoperable telecommunications and control facilities for small scale inverter interfaced solar PV and battery systems. This requirement is intended to ensure that Distributed Energy Resources (DERs) can be securely monitored and controlled to support demand side flexibility and grid stability. The action responds to the rapid growth of DERs in Ireland and the need for visibility, forecasting, and real time management on the low voltage network.

ESBN adopted a strategic and holistic approach, beginning with an international review of best practices, global standards, and DER control architectures. ESBN complemented this with internal technical assessments, including smart inverter testbeds, proofs of concept, and a nationwide field pilot using the IEEE 2030.5 communication protocol to test end to end DER controllability. The pilot involved real sites where ESBN deployed gateways, Modbus integrations, and communication interfaces to validate monitoring, curtailment, voltage control, and EV charging control. This combined desk based, lab, and field-based methodology ensured that technical recommendations were based on both analysis and practical deployment evidence.

Throughout the development of action 1.16, ESBN engaged regularly with the CRU to provide regular updates on progress. In addition, ESBN also engaged directly with DCEE as chair of the Smart Energy Services Working Group (SESWG) and the Sustainable Energy Authority of Ireland (SEAI).

The action produced a comprehensive technical whitepaper, a detailed network pilot performance report, and a set of recommended technical requirements for small scale solar PV and storage systems. The pilot successfully demonstrated Ireland’s first IEEE 2030.5 based utility control of rooftop PV, proving reliable telemetry, curtailment, voltage control, and EV charging management. These findings directly inform updates to ESBN standards, communication protocol requirements, and the future DER control architecture needed for flexibility markets.

ESBN provided a comprehensive briefing to ESBN’s Advisory Council in November 2025 outlining the background and context to the action, the development of the network pilot, pilot findings and basis for further work. The final ESBN report outlining the key findings and recommendations was submitted to the CRU in May 2026.

Next steps are likely to include further regulatory engagement with the CRU and ESBN’s wider industry stakeholders to further engage on how to progress this key programme of work.

A.12 NEDS Action 1.18: Smart Meter Data Access Code (CRU)

In February 2025, the CRU published a decision paper on the Smart Meter Data Access Code ('the Code'), which will provide for how parties can access the data collected by the smart meter and the rules around that access. A more detailed overview of the published decision is provided in Section 1.9 of this paper.

The aim of the Code is to ensure customers' interests and their respective smart meter data are protected and secure, while maintaining transparency in terms of its implementation and management.

Following the publication of this decision alongside the final version of the Code, the CRU commenced the implementation process. It is expected that full implementation will be realised in Q4 2026.

A.13 NEDS Action 2.1: Electricity network tariff reform (CRU)

Action 2.1 of the NEDS relates to the commencement of the Electricity Network Tariff Structure Review (ENTSR), which at the time of the last NEDS update was delayed due to lack of resources. Work on the ENTSR has started following a Request for Tender that closed in October 2025 and the reallocation of CRU staff to support the Review. The necessary external consultant resources commenced work on Phase 1 of the Review in February 2026. Ongoing work builds on the insights obtained from the 30 submissions from the Review's Call for Evidence published in September 2025 and sets the basis for Phase 1 of the ENTSR. This first project phase includes a consultation regarding the objectives and scope of the review in 2026 which will inform subsequent project phases (2027+).

The objective of NEDS Action 2.1 was for the re-commencement of the ENTSR. This has now occurred with Phase 1 which aims to define the objective and scope of the Review, the principles to guide decision making regarding network tariff structure reform and the associated stakeholder engagement strategy. The above are necessary to inform the planning of and preparation for subsequent phase(es) of the Review, including by the Network Companies. Phase 1 seeks to clearly communicate and set expectations of what the Review will deliver and ensure a shared understanding of the role of network tariff design in ensuring fit-for-purpose cost recovery and enabling objectives as set in the Climate Action Plan in the context of the CRU's remit.

The CRU has identified the ENTSR as one of its priority projects in its 2026 workplan.

A.14 NEDS Action 2.3: Increase flexibility provided by Demand Side Units (EirGrid)

The purpose of this action was to develop and publish a plan of work to improve active participation and performance of Demand Side Units (DSUs) in the market and remove barriers, including in that a plan to clarify expectations on DSUs to increase the flexibility, consider industry-suggested code changes, and describe technical updates to be implemented for TSO and MO systems.

In December 2024, EirGrid and SONI published their TSO Demand Side White Paper. This White Paper is intended to provide an overview of the drivers, characteristics, opportunities, requirements, issues, and potential initiatives to further develop demand side response to meet TSO power system needs. It identifies, from the TSOs' perspective, the primary high level power system needs and services which demand side response could have a role in meeting and providing and gives an indication of the TSOs' current view of the potential capability of various models of demand side response to contribute to meeting those needs and providing services. It also summarises and highlights issues and potential initiatives to be considered to help improve and develop demand side response, including those raised by the demand side response industry and by EirGrid and SONI, and sets out how these will be considered in future TSO planning work.

Following and building on this, the TSOs have been developing a TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan. This plan is intended to identify, prioritise, and plan timelines for the specific initiatives to be implemented. At the stage of when this action was due, the work on the plan was such that EirGrid and SONI had developed the high-level groups of activities and indicative timelines associated with them. Further work was and is still intended on engagement, identification, and prioritization of initiatives. While the work the TSOs are currently carrying out on developing the TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan is broader in scope than what is required to meet this action (e.g. considering all-island approach, not just considering DSUs, the work on that plan meets the requirement and all of the objectives for Action 2.3. Therefore, a document was developed and published containing a high-level indicative plan and timelines from this TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan work which meets the requirements of Action 2.3, and an explanation of where the objectives intended to be met for Action 2.3 will be included in the plan.

A plan of work to improve active participation and performance of DSUs in the market and remove barriers was published in July 2025⁶. It provides a high-level indication of the areas of work within the Demand Side Implementation Plan, still under development, that are relevant to the areas in the scope of NEDS action 2.3 on increasing flexibility from DSUs. Further work on developing the detailed initiatives within the TSO Demand Side Implementation Plan, and clarifying the exact timelines for their development, has continued since. EirGrid has started regular engagements with the CRU to discuss the development of this plan, and EirGrid plans to expand to further external engagement to gain feedback on the proposals for the plan. Once finalised it will enable EirGrid to continue with implementing the initiatives identified following the plan.

A.15 NEDS Action 2.5: Long Duration Energy Storage (Eirgrid)

The purpose of this action was to develop detailed procurement options informed by the Long Duration Energy Storage (LDES) Call for Evidence responses and report to the CRU. Work was carried out, in close coordination and with regular engagement with the CRU, on a consultation paper outlining a proposed procurement mechanism and operational considerations that the TSO considers are necessary to facilitate the introduction and operation of LDES in Ireland. This work took into account the feedback received from the responses to the LDES Call for Evidence previously published in 2023, and other external feedback received from engagements with the DSO, DCEE, other peer TSOs, storage industry representative bodies, and other industry update forums. This consultation paper summarises key services that LDES is intended to deliver, qualification system framework approach, initial proposal of pre-requirements, operational considerations to maximise the value of the contracted service capability, and market interaction considerations for LDES service providers.

The consultation document was published in October 2025⁷. The consultation has since concluded and work is ongoing to analyse the responses and form the recommendations, which are being discussed with the CRU, and final procurement recommendations will be subject to CRU approval. This will be thereafter followed by a more detailed consultation on the proposed contractual arrangements and relevant operational and market considerations. Regular updates are provided as part of industry update forums such as the Future Power Markets workshops and newsletters.

⁶ [Plan of work to improve active participation and performance of DSUs in the market and remove barriers.pdf](#)

⁷ [LDES Procurement Model Consultation Paper_0.pdf](#)

A.16 NEDS Action 2.7: Maximum Import Capacity Flexibility (ESBN)

Under Action 2.7, ESBN was required to review the opportunity to deliver flexibility through Maximum Import Capacity (MIC) on distribution system connection agreements and engage with the CRU.

To deliver on this action, ESBN undertook an international market review of how other jurisdictions have piloted and introduced offerings that facilitate flexible usage of customers' MIC (including a review of the Scottish and Southern Electricity Network (SSEN) ExtenDER project which was a feasibility study aimed at testing the market-based connection agreement to allow customers to connect earlier under transmission constraints). In addition, ESBN also engaged across relevant teams internally to better understand the challenges and opportunities that exist in implementing a flexible MIC solution, such as the SSEN ExtenDER project, on the Irish distribution system. As part of this internal review, ESBN noted that, in order to fulfil ESBNs' role to efficiently utilise the distribution network and minimise costs of network reinforcement for all customers, the identification of ongoing system improvement requirements is done based on actual load usage (rather than contracted load). To do otherwise would be to ignore the significant value of load diversity.

ESBN also considered and outlined to the CRU the findings from an internal review of the challenges and opportunities – in introducing a dynamic trading platform such as the SSEN ExtenDER project – on the Irish distribution system.

Following the review of the international market scan and engagement internally, learnings and recommendations on a path forward were developed which was ultimately that a trading platform is not the most suitable method of progressing flexibility through MIC at this time. However, as part of the work on action 2.7, ESBN also outlined the activities it is progressing to facilitate additional capacity on the distribution network, including flexible demand connections.

Moving forward, ESBN will engage with the CRU and EirGrid to discuss the findings and recommendations from this review.

A.17 NEDS Action 2.10: DSO Demand Flexibility Product (ESBN)

Under Action 2.10, ESBN was required to review potential options for DSO DFPs.

To address this action a framework of standardised flexibility products was developed. Using this framework, ESBN reviewed actions taken to pilot and scale flexibility products in previous years,

before reviewing the actions planned to develop new products and advance existing products in 2025, aligned to ESBNs' 2025-2029 Flexibility Multi-Year Plan.

In addition, ESBN also undertook an initial concept review of an industrial heat flexibility product. Following development of this concept review, ESBN engaged directly with the Department of Enterprise, Tourism and Employment (DETE) and Enterprise Ireland to discuss the concept review and to discuss potential ways in which ESBN could facilitate e-Heat customers within the limitations of competing priorities and ESBN's role within the industry. As part of this process, ESBN also undertook engagement with EirGrid.

Next steps will be undertaken based on the actions identified in the 2025-2029 Flexibility Multi-Year Plan and in collaboration with DETE, Enterprise Ireland, EirGrid and the industry stakeholders.

A.18 NEDS Action 2.11: DSO Flexibility Procurement (ESBN)

The objective of NEDS action 2.11 was to support the Climate Action Plan 2023 targets of achieving 20-30% flexible system demand by 2030 by procuring medium-duration flexibility products on the distribution system. More specifically, this action was primarily created to conduct a second consultation for medium duration flexibility, now known as the DFP.

ESBN published a second consultation on the DFP in October 2024 which was complemented by an external industry webinar on the DFP which was held on 26 November 2024. The publication of the second consultation paper followed an extensive period of engagement with the CRU as well as with EirGrid. The second consultation received 15 responses. ESBN collated and assessed these responses to further inform the design of the DFP. The CRU was kept informed throughout this process and ESBN published the second Demand Flexibility Product Recommendation Paper in May 2025 based on the outcome and responses from the second consultation. The publication of the second Demand Flexibility Product Recommendation Paper was accompanied by a CRU decision paper (CRU202560).

Most recently, ESBN published the DFP tender via the eTenders procurement portal. This represents a significant step forward in Ireland's flexibility targets as ESBN works towards a long-term goal of 500MW of flexible capacity for this product.

At the time of this publication, the outcome of the DFP procurement process is still ongoing as the tender results are currently being evaluated.

ESBN continues to engage closely with both the CRU and EirGrid regarding progress of the DFP and continues to engage with wider industry via ESBN's Advisory Council.

A.19 NEDS Action 2.12: Biomethane Lighthouse (ESBN)

The objective of this action was to develop and publish a plan to deliver the biomethane lighthouse project working with ESBNs' designated supporting bodies. The biomethane lighthouse project was intended to design and launch to market an extra-large energy user (XLEU) focused product aimed at maximising the potential to abate carbon from XLEUs participating in flexible demand; this would be achieved by XLEUs shifting their existing demand without the cost of increased emissions, i.e. low- or zero-carbon demand growth.

XLEUs would, during periods of network congestion, be requested to switch their electricity demand from the grid to on-site, behind-the-meter, low-carbon, back-up generation (fuelled by biomethane).

ESBN engaged closely with the designated supporting bodies including the CRU, GNI and the Biomethane Implementation Group on the design of the biomethane lighthouse project. ESBN also engaged wider industry representatives via ESBNs' Advisory Council where members were briefed on:

- the background and context for the development of the biomethane lighthouse project,
- the 'to be' design,
- the high-level ecosystem interactions, and
- next steps for the lighthouse project.

The plan and associated timelines developed by ESBN were ultimately presented to the CRU and the Biomethane Implementation Group in Q4 2024.

ESBN issued an Expression of Interest to all XLEUs to seek a partner to pilot the initiative from both a technical and economic point of view but, was unsuccessful in identifying a suitable customer via the Expression of Interest. During the engagement phase, both pre and during the Expression of Interest, ESBN did receive interest from LEUs for future sites but only if traditional capacity on the distribution system could be made available in the near term at existing or new sites in planning. This cross pollination is not allowable and outside the scope of the biomethane initiative. On a positive note, a significant dual fuel Supplier did canvas all their LEUs to assess their interest in participation. However, there was insufficient interest from the industry to proceed.

A.20 NEDS Action 2.15: European SCALE project monitoring (CRU)

Project Smart Charging Alignment for Europe (SCALE) is a Horizon 2020 project which was running for three years and was concluded at the end of 2025. Its aim was to advance smart

charging infrastructure and facilitate the mass deployment of EVs by identifying and reducing technical, organisational, economic, and policy barriers. Based on a collection of use-cases across EU, Project SCALE demonstrates that smart charging and V2X technologies are technically viable and can enable EVs to act as distributed flexibility resources, but their large-scale deployment is constrained primarily by system-level factors rather than technology. Across its workstreams, SCALE shows that user behaviour (requiring automation and simplicity), fragmented stakeholder roles, lack of interoperability standards, and limited market access for aggregated EV flexibility are key barriers.

SCALE provides clear evidence that EVs can become a significant source of demand-side flexibility, but only if regulatory frameworks enable participation in multiple markets, stream line aggregation, and value stacking. It also reinforces the need to prioritise fleet-led deployment, interoperability standards, and “smart-by-default” consumer approaches to unlock participation at scale. Importantly, the project highlights that EV integration must be treated as a whole-system challenge, requiring alignment between distribution network planning, transport policy, and flexibility market design. For each barrier area, Project SCALE provides a list of lessons learned and identified barriers for accelerating Smart EV charging and vehicle-to-anything bidirectional charging which could help informing the focus of the NEDS update.

In parallel, CRU have been monitoring developments and initiatives in policy, and consultations on NEDS related topics, including from ACER, individual Member States and the EC.

A.21 NEDS Action 2.16: Optimise EV fleet charging (ESBN)

Under action 2.16, ESBN was tasked to develop and publish a plan to optimise EV fleet charging through technology and software solutions.

ESBN undertook a structured three-step project aimed at understanding and enabling the optimisation of EV fleet charging within Ireland’s distribution network. Step 1 focused on establishing a strong foundational understanding by conducting an extensive review of global initiatives, technologies, and strategies related to EV fleet optimization. This phase also involved identifying key opportunities, challenges, and gaps specific to the Irish energy landscape, helping to frame the relevance and applicability of international best practices to Ireland.

Step 2 transitioned from research to application by developing a simulation-based case study. This phase explored the potential benefits of smart charging in a real-world context, using fleet operations near a substation in Dublin as a representative urban scenario. By simulating various fleet types and operational constraints, the study examined the effects of controlled charging

strategies on key network metrics such as peak load reduction, congestion management, and fleet availability.

Step 3 synthesised the findings from the previous phases to create a future oriented draft roadmap for the broader rollout of optimised fleet charging strategies across Ireland. This draft roadmap aligns with ESBNs' goals to strengthen the grid resilience, support the electrification of transport and accelerate the transition to a smarter, more sustainable energy system.

ESBN also engaged with the designated supporting bodies to share the draft 2.16 report for review and input, and where appropriate ESBN reflected supporting body feedback into the final report in advance of submission to the CRU. ESBN will publish on its website the report on NEDS action 2.16 Optimise EV Fleet Charging as part of the refresh to ESBNs' DMSO Blueprint and Roadmaps, which ESBN currently expects to conclude in H2 2026.

A.22 NEDS Action 2.17: Smart EV charging availability (ESBN)

The objective of action 2.17 was for ESBN to develop and publish a technical assessment of how the available smart EV charging and V2G capacity can be maximised through network operations. It also provided recommendations for the scalable integration of smart charging and V2G across the Irish distribution system.

To deliver on this action, ESBN has:

1. Undertaken a global review of international smart charging and V2G trials to identify best practices;
2. Designed and run pilots such as a Flex-Charging project, commercial V2G feasibility studies, and the Dingle V2G trial to understand real-world behaviour, grid impacts, hardware readiness, and user interactions;
3. Conducted technical assessments regarding charger technologies, interoperability standards, EV adoption trends, and network constraints across Ireland.

ESBN produced a comprehensive technical report outlining Ireland's smart charging and V2G landscape including key challenges, opportunities for optimisation, and specific recommendations for network-aligned planning, interoperability, customer engagement, and integration with DSO operations.

ESBN also engaged with the designated supporting bodies to share the draft 2.17 report for review and input and, where appropriate, ESBN reflected supporting body feedback into the final report in advance of submission to the CRU. ESBN will publish on its website the report on NEDS action

2.17 Smart EV charging availability as part of the refresh to ESBNs' DMSO Blueprint and Roadmaps, which ESNB currently expects to conclude in H2 2026.

Next steps include deeper stakeholder engagement, forming a NEDS working group, and advancing upcoming pilots such as the EV Flexible/Smart Charging product.

A.23 NEDS Action 2.19: Electricity system emissions information (Eirgrid)

This action assessed how real-time electricity system emissions are currently reported and explored opportunities to better integrate emissions information into Transmission System Operator (TSO) decision-making within existing regulatory requirements. The approach involved reviewing current emissions calculation methodologies, examining operational, market and regulatory frameworks governing dispatch, including a clear description of current reporting practices and limitations to real-time and unit-level transparency. The report also identifies a set of potential practical options for enhancements and improvements which could be considered in future to improve transparency and carbon awareness without compromising the relevant regulatory requirements, such as enhanced visualisation on carbon intensity forecasting and reporting, further incorporation of emissions modelling into evaluating operational policy changes and flexibility initiatives, and improved carbon emissions reporting for demand-side and emerging technologies.

A.24 NEDS Action 2.22: Electricity Guarantees of Origin (CRU)

The purpose of this action was to review data and identify design options for more granular Guarantees of Origin (GOs), with a location of generation and a time stamp on them. This is seen as an effort to better link local demand for electricity with supply.

Consultations took place between SEMO and the CRU. SEMO indicated that guidance on these granular GOs from the Association of Issuing Bodies (AIB) and Grexel would be needed in the first instance in order to identify more granular design options. At the time of this publication, GOs continue to be issued on a monthly basis.

The CRU will continue to engage with SEMO to ensure ongoing monitoring as to when guidance is ultimately provided by AIB and Grexel. The CRU will then engage with SEMO to review this guidance and market changes once available.

A.25 NEDS Action 2.23: Certification of additionality for (a) power and (b) renewable gas (CRU)

An assessment was conducted by the CRU. This indicated that a clear approach to additionality for renewable gas exists as per criteria provided under Article 5 of Delegated EU Regulation (2023/1184), supplementing Directive (EU) 2018/2001. However, the opportunity for new (additional energy certification) power products to demonstrate additionality should be reviewed again in the short to medium term (e.g. 3-5yrs). Necessary inputs are required to be further developed, whereby a definition, and the associated policy for additionality at a national level are set out, e.g. by the Government, in order to progress without the risk of confusion or misalignment across the industry. Furthermore, it is not envisaged that there will be an opportunity for renewable energy generation in Ireland in the short term over and above Ireland's current baseline need. As such, it is recommended that these relevant aspects should continue to be monitored and for this action to be revisited in future. This is aligned with the Large Energy Users Connection Policy Decision paper that was published by the CRU in December 2025.

A.26 NEDS Action 3.2A: Enhanced quality and accessibility of network information (ESBN)

There are 2 aspects to how this objective has been delivered by ESB Networks:

1. Publication of Network Scenario Headroom reports as part of the Distribution Network Development Plan (DNDP)–
 - a. first publication end 2024;
 - b. Updated publication end 2025.

To be updated annually in the future⁸

2. Ongoing publication and regular updates of the Availability Capacity Heatmaps⁹

⁸ [DNDP | ESB Networks](#)

⁹ [ESB Networks capacity heatmap for network planning | ESB Networks](#)

Network Scenario Headroom reports

The Network Scenario Headroom report was developed using a structured methodology with consistent, standardised assumptions aligned to ESB Networks' planning requirements and focussed on substation-level capacity.

Key data inputs for the reports:

- Special Load Readings (SLRs) – reflecting peak load at system peak,
- defined load-growth scenarios,
- ESNB Connected-Contracted Energized Generation (for the generation reports), as well as other
- network reinforcement plans.

Availability Capacity Heatmaps

The heat map has been in place for a number of years. However, as part of this NEDS action ESNB is updating the view on a more regular basis. The availability capacity heatmap provides an indication of available **transformer capacity, at substation level**¹⁰ and at all voltage levels, for new demand and generation customers. It is a user-friendly and interactive map that shows how much demand or generation could be added into a substation without reinforcement. It empowers potential customers and helps them have a better understanding as to where connection is possible. Unlike the NSHR – which forecasts load growth, the heatmap is a snapshot, representing a moment in time, of a continually changing network system.

The availability capacity heatmap is an important aid to assisting customers in their considerations relating to the need for electrical capacity. However, the map does not and should not replace a full and formal application to ESB Networks. Submission of an application will facilitate a full assessment of the impact of the new load on the system and will also secure the customer a place in the queue should there be a shortage of capacity.

¹⁰ The heatmap does not guarantee the same capacity is available in the upstream networks.